

MINOR (2023)

Section: A (2 marks)

What is Women's Studies?

Women's Studies is an interdisciplinary field of study that examines gender's role in human experience and how it intersects with other identities like race, class, sexuality, and ability. Women's Studies is also known as Gender Studies or Feminist Studies.

Or

Women's Studies, also referred to as Gender Studies or Feminist Studies, is the interdisciplinary study of how intersectionality of gender, race, age, class, nationality, ethnicity, ability, sexuality, and other differences impact almost every facet of the social, political, and cultural experience.

When and where was the Centre of Women's Studies in the international field first started?

San Diego State College (now San Diego State University) in the United States of America first introduced Women's Studies in its curriculum in 1970.

When did the second wave begin?

The second wave feminist movement took place between 1960 and 1970 and focused on issues of equality and discrimination.

When is International Women's Day celebrated?

8th March is considered the International Women's Day globally, celebrating the social, economic, cultural, and political achievements of women. The day also marks a call to action for accelerating women's equality.

Or

In 1975, during the International Women's Year, the United Nations began celebrating 8th March as International Women's Day. The day also marks a call to action for accelerating women's equality every year.

Which is the first Women's Studies Centre in India?

The first Women's Studies Centre (WSC) in India was established in 1974 at the S.N.D.T Women's University in Mumbai. The WSC was directed by Neera Desai, a Sociology Professor at the university.

Write the full form of AIWC.

All India Women's Conference is the full form of AIWC, an organization dedicated to improving women's education and social welfare in India.

What is the meaning of the word 'suffrage'?

The word 'suffrage' means the right to vote in political elections. The women's suffrage movement made the question of women's voting rights an important political issue in the 19th century across globe.

Section: B (5 marks)**Discuss the importance of Seneca Falls Convention.**

The Seneca Falls Convention was the first women's rights convention in global history. It advertised itself as "a convention to discuss the social, civil, and religious condition and rights of woman". Held in the Wesleyan Chapel of the town of Seneca Falls, New York, it spanned two days over July 19 to 20, 1848.

Pioneering women leaders

The Seneca Falls Convention was organized by five women: Elizabeth Cady Stanton, Lucretia Coffin Mott, Martha Coffin Wright, Mary Ann McClintock, and Jane Hunt. The Seneca Falls Convention in the United States is considered a pivotal moment in the women's suffrage movement as it —

Launched the women's suffrage movement

The convention in 1848 set the stage for the decades-long women's rights movement that led to the 19th Amendment in 1920, granting women the right to vote.

Established a framework for women's rights

The convention's Declaration of Sentiments, written by Elizabeth Cady Stanton, tied women's rights to the country's natural-rights tradition. The declaration called for sexual equality in society, including women's right to vote.

Promoted collaboration between women's rights and abolitionist movements

The convention was held in upstate New York, a center of anti-slavery activity. Some activists believed the two issues were intertwined and should be addressed simultaneously.

Featured speeches by prominent figures

Frederick Douglass, an African American abolitionist, gave a speech in favor of women's suffrage.

Promoted equality within marriage

The convention also focused on increasing equality within marriage and decreasing the economic dependence of women.

Write a note on the growth of Women's Studies in India.

Development of Women Studies Centres in Indian Universities and Colleges is meant to help India achieve her UN Sustainable Development Goal of Promoting Equality and Empowerment of Women. The political context of post 1975 researches was distinctly different as the *Towards Equality Report* 1974, provided the framework to situate Women's Studies in India and believed to be the 'watershed in the field of Women's Studies in the country' as remarked by Neera Desai.

Desai states that the priority areas identified for research during the first phase included:

- Changes in occupational structure: emerging trends
- Evaluation of development programs;
- Patterns of family organization and socialization practices
- Causes and consequences of excess of female over male migration
- Women's movement
- Role in the decision-making process

In this context the pioneering efforts of the S.N.D.T Women's University Research Unit on Women's Studies, established in 1974 needs to be mentioned. The Indian Council for Social Science Research (ICSSR) also set up a Women's Studies Unit in the mid- 1970s, to facilitate research focusing on women through fellowships/ grants. The National Conference on Women's Studies in 1980 was more of a movement and not limited to conference proceedings as stated by Vina Mazumdar. Further what was important about the National Conference on Women's Studies 1980, that the decision to form Indian Association of Women's Studies (IAWS) was taken. The association later seeks to break the isolation between academic activities and social action by opening its membership to all, engaged in teaching, research and action for women's development.

Discuss the rise of Women's suffrage movement in Britain.

In Great Britain woman suffrage was first advocated by Mary Wollstonecraft in her book *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman* (1792) and was demanded by the Chartist movement of the 1840s. The demand for woman suffrage was increasingly taken up by prominent liberal intellectuals in England from the 1850s on, notably by John Stuart Mill and his wife, Harriet.

The first woman suffrage committee was formed in Manchester in 1865, and in 1867 Mill presented to Parliament this society's petition, which demanded the vote for women. The Reform Bill of 1867 contained no provision for woman suffrage, but meanwhile woman suffrage societies were forming in most of the major cities of Britain. The succeeding years saw the defeat of every major suffrage bill brought before Parliament.

In 1897 the various suffragist societies united into one National Union of Women's Suffrage Societies, thus bringing a greater degree of coherence and organization to the movement. Out of frustration at the lack of governmental action, however, a segment of the woman suffrage movement became more militant under the leadership of Emmeline Pankhurst and her daughter Christabel.

When World War I began, the woman suffrage organizations shifted their energies to aiding the war effort, and their effectiveness did much to win the public wholeheartedly to the cause of woman suffrage. The need for the enfranchisement of women was finally recognized by most members of Parliament and the resulting Representation of the People Act was passed by the House of Commons in June 1917 and by the House of Lords in February 1918. Under this act, all women age 30 or over received the complete franchise. In 1928 the voting age for women was lowered to 21 to place women voters on an equal footing with male voters.